HomeoClinic User Guide

Covers releases R0 + R1 + R2 + R3 (milestones M0 + M1 + M2 + M3): "Paper replacement".

This guide is cumulative. Each milestone's guide includes everything from the previous milestones plus the new features. This edition (R3) adds on-screen case taking, follow-up visits, and a live Today screen on top of the patient register (R2) and the setup/lock/backup features (R1). Later editions (R4, R5, ...) will add prescriptions and printing, billing, and the repertory.

HomeoClinic is a fully offline desktop application. It makes no network calls of its own: your patient data never leaves your computer, and everything in this guide works with the internet disconnected.

---

1. Installing and opening the app (R0)

Ubuntu / Linux

You received one of these files:

- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`** — portable, no installation. 1. Make it executable: right-click → Properties → Permissions → "Allow executing file as program", or in a terminal run `chmod +x HomeoClinic_*.AppImage`. 2. Double-click it (or run `./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.AppImage`).
- **`HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`** — installs into the system menu. 1. Install it: `sudo apt install ./HomeoClinic_<version>_amd64.deb`. 2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from your applications menu.

Windows

1. Run the **`.exe`** (NSIS) or **`.msi`** installer and follow the prompts. The app installs per-user; no administrator rights are required.
2. Launch "HomeoClinic" from the Start menu.

What you should see

- The application window opens within a few seconds.
- On a **brand-new installation**, the app opens the **first-run setup wizard** (see section 2).
- On an **already set-up installation**, the app opens the **lock screen** and asks for your PIN (see section 3).

The main application shell has:

- a **top bar** with a patient search box (press **F2** to focus it) and buttons for Help (**F1**) and Lock (**Ctrl+L**);
- a **left navigation** with Today, Patients, Backup and Settings (some items are disabled until later releases add their screens);
- a **status bar** at the bottom showing the save state, the last backup time, and the licence/trial state.

> In R3 the working areas are: setup, lock, the **Today** home (now with live due/overdue lists), the **Patients** register and search, **case taking** and **follow-up visits** (new in R3), and Backup. Prescriptions, billing and the repertory arrive in later releases.

---

2. First-run setup wizard (R1)

The first time you open the app on a new computer, the setup wizard runs automatically. It has at most four short steps and should take only a couple of minutes. The language selector at the top is English for this release.

Step 1 — Doctor profile

Enter your professional details. These print on every prescription and receipt in later releases.

- **Full name** (required)
- **Qualification** (required) — e.g. BHMS, MD(Hom)
- **Registration number** and **Council** (required)
- **Phone** and **Email** (optional)
- **Signature image** and **Clinic logo** (optional)

Click **Next**. Required fields that are empty show an inline message under the field.

Step 2 — Clinic profile

- **Clinic name** (required)
- **Address** (required)
- **Default consultation fee** and **Default follow-up fee** (required) — amounts are shown in Indian number format
- **Phone**, **GSTIN**, **Timings** (optional)

Click **Next**.

Step 3 — Security (PIN and recovery code)

1. **Set a PIN** (4 to 6 digits) and **confirm** it. This PIN protects all your patient data.
2. Choose the **auto-lock** time (how many idle minutes before the app locks itself; default 15).
3. After the PIN is confirmed, the app shows a **one-time recovery code**. - **Write it down or click Print.** It is shown only once. - If you ever forget your PIN, this recovery code is the only way back into your data.
4. Tick **"I have saved my recovery code"** to continue.

> **Keep the recovery code safe and separate from the computer.** There is no way to recover your data without either the PIN or the recovery code — this is what keeps patient data private.

Step 4 — Licence

- Select **Start 30-day free trial**. This release uses a built-in **Development trial**; buying and importing a real licence arrives in a later release.

Click **Finish setup**. The app creates your encrypted database, starts the trial, and opens the **Today** screen, unlocked and ready.

> **Setup must be finished before anything else is available.** The rest of the app cannot be reached until you complete the wizard and start the trial here. **Finish setup** is the only way out of the wizard; there is no shortcut that skips the trial. (If you close the app mid-setup, it reopens on the wizard where you left off.)

---

3. Locking and unlocking the app (R1)

Your data sits behind a single PIN entry.

When the app locks

- **On every launch** after setup is complete.
- **Automatically** after the idle time you chose (default 15 minutes).
- **On demand** — press **Ctrl+L** or click the **Lock** button in the top bar at any time.

Unlocking

1. Type your **PIN** and press **Enter** (or click **Unlock**).
2. A correct PIN unlocks immediately and returns you to where you were.
3. A wrong PIN shows an inline message and lets you try again — the app never locks you out or wipes anything for a wrong entry.

Forgot your PIN

1. On the lock screen, click **Forgot PIN?**.
2. Enter the **recovery code** from setup, then set and confirm a **new PIN**.
3. Click **Reset PIN**. You can now unlock with the new PIN.

> Unlocking and recovery happen entirely on your computer — no internet is used or required.

Trial status in the status bar (R1)

The status bar shows your licence state, e.g. **"Licence: Trial — expires (N days left)"**. The days-remaining counts down against a tamper-proof clock: setting the computer's date backwards does **not** extend the trial.

---

4. Registering patients (R2)

Open **Patients** from the left navigation, then **New patient** (or press **F4**). This opens the registration form (screen S06).

The registration form

- **Name** (required).
- **Age** (required) **or Date of birth** — entering a date of birth fills the age automatically; otherwise type the age directly (it may be estimated).
- **Sex**, **Mobile**, **Alternate mobile**, **Address**, **City**, **Occupation**, **Marital status**, **Blood group**, **Referred by** — all optional.
- A **patient code** (e.g. `HC-000123`) is assigned automatically with your clinic prefix. Codes are **never reused**, even after a patient is deleted and restored.
- Required fields validate inline; fees and money show in Indian number format.

Patient photo (R2)

In the form you can attach a photo two ways:

- **Choose file** — pick an image file from disk.
- **Use webcam** — capture from the computer's default camera. The app asks for camera access; if a camera is unavailable or access is denied, it tells you and you can fall back to a file.

You can **remove**, **retake**, or **swap** the photo (file ↔ webcam) before or after saving — the photo updates with the patient record.

Duplicate warning

Before saving, if another patient matches on **name + mobile** or **name + date of birth** (including common Indian-name spelling variants), the form shows a **duplicate warning** listing the possible matches. It does not block you — you decide whether it's truly a new patient.

Click **Save**. The new patient is stored and becomes **findable immediately** in search.

---

5. Finding patients — global search (R2)

Press **F2** or **Ctrl+K** (or click the top-bar search box) to open the global search overlay from any screen. It finds patients from the first character you type — no need to choose a field.

What it matches

- **Name** — any word prefix, e.g. typing `ram ku` finds "Ramesh Kumar".
- **Patient ID** — full code or just the digits, e.g. `123` finds `HC-000123`.
- **Mobile** — any 4 or more consecutive digits, ignoring `+91` and spaces.
- **City** and **family member name**.
- **Phonetic / spelling variants** of Indian names — e.g. `sarma` finds "Sharma", `laxmi` finds "Lakshmi", `mohd` finds "Mohammad". Exact matches always rank above phonetic ones.

Using it

- Results update as you type and each row shows photo, name, ID, age/sex, mobile, city, last visit and dues.
- Use **Up/Down** to move and **Enter** to open the patient's dashboard. **Enter** on an exact ID or mobile match opens that patient directly.
- When the box is empty, your **last 20 opened patients** are shown.
- Search stays fast — results appear in well under a tenth of a second even with tens of thousands of patients.

---

6. The patient list and filters (R2)

Open **Patients** to see the full list with a filter panel (screen S05).

- **Filters available now:** last visit older than N days, next follow-up (today / overdue / date range), age range, sex, city, and "has dues". Filters combine together; results are sortable by name, ID, last visit and next follow-up.
- **Export CSV** writes the current filtered, sorted list to a file.
- Some filters (by remedy, diagnosis, potency, case-note text, tags, and saved filters) are shown but **disabled** — they switch on in later releases once more case and prescription data exists.

---

7. The patient dashboard (R2)

Clicking a patient (from search or the list) opens their dashboard (screen S07):

- **Demographics banner** — name, code, **age**/sex, mobile, city, referred by, photo — plus any **allergies / alerts**. The **age updates itself** over time from the date of birth, so it is always current.
- **Family** — linked family members with quick-switch.
- **Take case / Follow-up** — starts the first case, or (once a first case is saved) a **Follow-up**. After the first case is recorded, the plain "New visit" is greyed out so you don't accidentally start a second first case — use **Follow-up** instead (see sections 8 and 9). New in R3.
- **Visit timeline** builds up as you record visits (R3).

A **dues** area and a **Clear dues** button appear as **disabled placeholders** — automatic fee totals and marking dues paid arrive with the billing release (R5).

From the dashboard you can **Edit** the patient, **Export** their record (PDF or JSON), or move them to the **recycle bin**.

---

8. Taking a case (R3, new)

From a patient's dashboard, click **Take case** (or **New visit** for a patient with no prior visit; shortcut **F5**). This opens the case form (screen S08) — the on-screen replacement for the paper case sheet. It is built around a **free-writing journal**, so it works the way you write on paper.

The complaint box — write freely, insert tables

- Each complaint has **one big editable box**. You type the case into it as free text, exactly as you would write on a sheet.
- **Add entry** stamps a **date header** and starts a fresh block beneath it. The box is a **running dated log**: every time you open the case (and on every follow-up) you add a new dated entry under the previous ones, so the whole history of the complaint stays in one place.
- **Everything is editable** — all the text, and every cell of every table you insert, can be changed at any time.

Inserting tables (vitals, modalities, prescription)

Buttons at the top of the box drop structured **tables** into your writing:

- **Record vitals** opens a small pop-up. Enter **blood pressure as two fields — systolic and diastolic** — plus pulse, weight and height; **BMI is computed live**. Press **Record** and a **vitals table** is inserted into the box. You can edit any cell afterwards.
- **Record modalities** (aggravations / ameliorations) inserts an editable **modalities table** the same way.
- **Add prescription** inserts an editable **medicine table** with columns **Medicine, Potency, Dosage, Instructions** — add a new table each time you prescribe. In this release the prescription table is a **preview**: it is saved with the case, but formatted printing arrives with the prescription release (R4).

On a **follow-up** the same buttons read **Update vitals**, **Update modalities** and **Update prescription**, and they add a fresh table under a new dated entry rather than replacing the earlier one.

The side sections

Alongside the box are the structured history sections from the template:

- **Physical generals** — appetite, thirst, cravings, aversions, stool, urine, sweat, sleep, dreams, thermal state, and now **Constitution**, **Diet**, a **Sun aggravation (Yes/No)** choice, and a free-text **Notes** field.
- **Mental generals** and **Past history** — long-text boxes.
- **Family history** — two tabs, **Maternal** and **Paternal**, kept separately.
- **Investigations** — two tabs: **Suggested** (what you have advised) and **Submitted** (reports the patient has brought back; this is where you **upload lab / scan reports** — see below).
- **Menstrual / obstetric** (female patients) and **Child development** (patients under 14) appear only when relevant.
- Sections are **collapsible**, and clicking a section in the left rail **toggles it** on or off so you only see what you use.

Uploading lab and scan reports

In **Investigations → Submitted**, click **Upload report** to attach a **PDF or image** (ultrasound, CT, blood report, etc.). Each report shows a **PDF / Image** badge and an optional caption; you can **open** it or **remove** it (with confirmation). Reports are stored **encrypted** on your computer and never leave it.

Saving — autosave plus a Save button

- The case **autosaves every 2 seconds and whenever you leave a field**; the status shows "Saving..." then **"Saved hh:mm"**.
- There is also an explicit **Save** button. Pressing it forces an immediate save and confirms **"Saved"** — for peace of mind that the case is written.

- If the app closes — or the computer crashes — **mid-typing**, reopening the case restores the last saved content (text **and** the inserted tables) with **nothing lost**.

> The **"Send to repertory"** action is not shown yet; it switches on when the repertory ships in a later release.

---

9. Follow-up visits (R3, new)

Once a patient has a saved first case, the dashboard offers **Follow-up** (the plain "New visit" is greyed out, because the first case is already recorded — so you can't start a second first case by mistake). Click **Follow-up** to record a return consultation.

A follow-up **opens the very same journal box** as the case, already filled with the previous entries:

- The complaint box **pre-loads** with the earlier dated entries and the prior complaint titles, so you have the full history in front of you.
- Click **Add entry** to stamp **today's date** and write what has changed.
- The table buttons now read **Update vitals / Update modalities / Update prescription**; each inserts a fresh table under the new dated entry, so you can see the earlier readings and the new ones together.
- **Next follow-up**: set the next appointment with the quick buttons **7d / 15d / 1m / 2m** or a **custom date**. The scheduled date is shown on the visit and puts the patient onto the Today screen for that date (section 10).
- Like the case, the follow-up **autosaves** and has an explicit **Save** button.

When you finish and save, the patient's **Today / home screen updates** to reflect the follow-up you entered — if you scheduled a next appointment the patient appears under **Due today / Overdue** on the right date, and the visit shows under **Registered today**.

> The **progress chart** and formatted **Prescribe / print** actions are not active yet; they switch on in later releases (the prescription table you add in the box is saved as a preview in the meantime).

---

10. The Today screen (R3 — now live)

Today is the home screen (press **F3**). From R3 it shows three live lists, driven by the follow-up dates you set:

- **Due today** — patients whose next follow-up falls on today's date.
- **Overdue** — patients whose follow-up date has passed (most overdue first).
- **Registered today** — the visits recorded today.

Each row shows the patient's photo, name, code and age/sex; click or press **Enter** to open their dashboard. Set a follow-up date on a visit and the patient appears under **Due today** on that date, then moves to **Overdue** afterwards.

Today also shows the **backup warning banner** when your last good backup is more than 7 days old (see section 11). The licence-renewal reminder becomes live in a later release.

---

11. Backing up your data (R1)

Backup becomes available **after** you finish the first-run setup (section 2). Once setup is complete, open **Backup** from the left navigation (or click the "Last backup" chip in the status bar).

Back up now (to a folder or USB drive)

1. Under **Back up now**, choose a destination with **Choose folder...** or **Use USB drive...**.
2. Enter a **backup password** (at least 8 characters). The first time, you also confirm it.
3. Optionally tick **Remember on this PC** so scheduled backups never ask for the password again on this computer.
4. Click **Back up now**.

The app writes a single encrypted file, `*.hcbak`, containing your database and attachments (patients, their photos, and now your cases and visits). After writing, it verifies the file (checksum + decrypt test).

> The backup password is **separate** from your app PIN. You need this password to restore the backup on another computer, so store it safely.

Automatic daily backups

- Automatic daily backup keeps the last **14 daily**, **8 weekly** and **12 monthly** copies, pruning older ones.
- It runs on app close or the first launch of the day and uses your remembered password, so it never interrupts you.

Backup health

- The screen and the status-bar chip show when the **last good backup** ran.
- If the last successful backup is **more than 7 days old**, a warning banner appears prompting you to back up.

---

12. Restoring from a backup (R1)

Use this to recover data, or to move to a new computer (install HomeoClinic on the new PC, then restore).

1. On the **Backup** screen, under **Restore from a backup**, click **Choose backup file (.hcbak)...**.
2. **Step 1 — File and password:** select the `.hcbak` file and enter its backup password. A wrong password is refused here and the wizard does not continue.
3. **Step 2 — Preview:** the app shows what the backup contains (counts and dates) **without changing anything yet**.
4. **Step 3 — Confirm:** click **Restore**. Before replacing anything, the app takes a **safety copy of your current data**, then swaps in the restored data. A mistaken restore is therefore recoverable.

After restore, your doctor and clinic profile, **all patients** (with photos) and **all cases and visits** come back.

> Upgrading from an older version keeps your data: installing a new release over an existing one migrates your database automatically and your previous backups still open.
>
> Backup and restore perform **no network calls** and work fully offline.

---

13. Quick reference — keyboard shortcuts (R0–R3)

Key	Action
F1	Help
F2 / Ctrl+K	Focus / open global patient search
F3	Today
F4	New patient
F5	New visit for the open patient (case or follow-up)
Alt+←	Back (up one level: case/follow-up → dashboard → list → Today)
Ctrl+= / Ctrl+-	Zoom text and layout in / out
Ctrl+0	Reset zoom
Ctrl+L	Lock the app now
Up / Down	Move through search results / lists
Enter	Open the selected patient / confirm the current step / unlock
Esc	Close a dialog or the search overlay (never discards data)

> **Back** is always in the **same place** (top of the screen) on every screen, and **Alt+←** does the same from the keyboard. Going back never discards your work — the case is already autosaved.
>
> **Zoom** scales both the text and the layout, so you can make the whole app larger on a big consulting-room screen or smaller to fit more in. When the window is **maximised / full-screen, the layout now fills the whole screen** rather than sitting in a narrow centred column.

---

14. Privacy and safety notes (R1–R3)

- **Offline only.** HomeoClinic makes no network connections of its own and opens no listening ports.

- **Encrypted at rest.** Your database, patient photos and case records are encrypted; the key is derived from your PIN.
- **Autosave never loses clinical work** — cases and follow-ups save continuously and restore after a crash or an accidental close.
- **No data in logs.** Diagnostic logs never contain patient details.
- **Never lost by accident.** Patients are soft-deleted to a 30-day recycle bin; permanent deletion asks for your PIN.
- **Your data is always recoverable** with your PIN or your recovery code, and always **exportable** (per-patient PDF/JSON, filtered-list CSV, or a full encrypted backup).

Appendix — what is NOT in this release

The following arrive in later milestones and are intentionally absent or shown as **disabled placeholders** in R3: formatted prescriptions and printing (the prescription table you add to the case is saved as a preview only), billing — including the **dues** total and **Clear dues** — and reports, the repertory / Materia Medica and "Send to repertory", per-complaint progress charts, buying/importing a real licence, custom case-template editing, voice dictation and the body diagram, and the appointment book. When those ship, this guide will be extended to cover them.

HomeoClinic User Guide — R3 edition (M0 + M1 + M2 + M3). Generated from `documents/user-guide/HomeoClinic-User-Guide-R3.md`*.*